NATIONAL SENIOR CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION
NOVEMBER 2025

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE: PAPER I

Time: 3 hours 100 marks

PLEASE READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY

1. This question paper consists of 11 pages and an Insert of 12 pages (i–xii).
2. Please check that your question paper is complete.
3. Detach the Insert from the centre of the question paper.
4. Answers must be written in the Answer Book.
5. Answer all questions in your own words unless instructed to do otherwise.
6. Read the questions carefully.
7. Please number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
8. Do not write in the margin.
9. Manage your time carefully and consider the mark allocation when formulating your answers.
10. It is in your own interest to write legibly and to present your work neatly.

IEB Copyright © 2025

QUESTION 1 COMPREHENSION

Refer to **TEXT 1** on pages (i) and (ii) of the Insert, entitled '*The Meaning of Life – Who Cares?*' by Emily O'Neil, and then answer the questions that follow.

1.1 Explain how the title reveals the writer's attitude. (2)

1.2 Refer to the last sentence of paragraph 2: 'Life is not … in its unpredictability.'

Discuss the effectiveness of both metaphors in reinforcing the writer's argument. (3)

1.3 Refer to paragraph 3.

Discuss how the writer positions the reader to view the impact of 'society' on people. (4)

1.4 Refer to paragraph 4.

Explain why the writer has used rhetorical questions in this paragraph. (3)

1.5 Consider paragraphs 5–6.

Show how the writer's intention is enhanced by the tone used. (4)

1.6 Refer to paragraph 7.

Identify the figure of speech in 'Meaning, like beauty, is subjective' and comment on its effectiveness in the context of paragraph 7. (3)

1.7 Consider the last sentence of paragraph 8: 'Instead of chasing … and deeply personal.'

Explain in your own words what the writer means by this statement. (2)

IEB Copyright © 2025

1.8 Refer to **TEXT 1** and the seen poem, 'nobody loses all the time', by ee cummings below, and then answer the question that follows.

nobody loses all the time
e. e. cummings

nobody loses all the time

i had an uncle named
Sol who was a born failure and
nearly everybody said he should have gone
into vaudeville perhaps because my Uncle Sol could
sing McCann He Was A Diver on Xmas Eve like Hell Itself which
may or may not account for the fact that my Uncle

Sol indulged in that possibly most inexcusable
of all to use a highfalootin phrase
luxuries that is or to
wit farming and be
it needlessly
added

my Uncle Sol's farm
failed because the chickens
ate the vegetables so
my Uncle Sol had a
chicken farm till the
skunks ate the chickens when

my Uncle Sol
had a skunk farm but
the skunks caught cold and
died and so
my Uncle Sol imitated the
skunks in a subtle manner

or by drowning himself in the watertank
but somebody who'd given my Uncle Sol a Victor
Victrola and records while he lived presented to
him upon the auspicious occasion of his decease a
scrumptious not to mention splendiferous funeral with
tall boys in black gloves and flowers and everything and

i remember we all cried like the Missouri
when my Uncle Sol's coffin lurched because
somebody pressed a button
(and down went
my Uncle
Sol

and started a worm farm)

[Source: Anthology, *Clusters*, Gerald de Villiers]

IEB Copyright © 2025

Critically discuss how the writer of **TEXT 1** (Emily O'Neil) might respond to the speaker's view of Uncle Sol in 'nobody loses all the time'.

Refer to specific diction from **TEXT 1**, and the poem 'nobody loses all the time' to support your answer. (4)

[25]

IEB Copyright © 2025

QUESTION 2 SUMMARY

Refer to **TEXT 2A**, **TEXT 2B**, and **TEXT 2C** on pages (iii) and (iv) of the Insert.

Your school has decided to implement a phone-free academic day, which you support.

Using **TEXT 2A**, **TEXT 2B**, and **TEXT 2C as your only sources**, write a speech that you will deliver to the junior grades of your high school, highlighting the importance of a phone-free academic day.

- Your summary must be in the form of **one** paragraph, using **no more than 90 words**.
- Provide an **exact** word count at the end of the summary.
- Your language must be accurate and in an appropriate register.
- Use your own words. 'Cutting and pasting' of information is not acceptable.

[10]

IEB Copyright © 2025

QUESTION 3 SEEN POETRY

Refer to the seen poems, 'Remember' by Christina Rosetti (**TEXT 3A**) and 'Ozymandias of Egypt' by Percy Bysshe Shelley (**TEXT 3B**) on page (v) of the Insert and then answer the questions that follow.

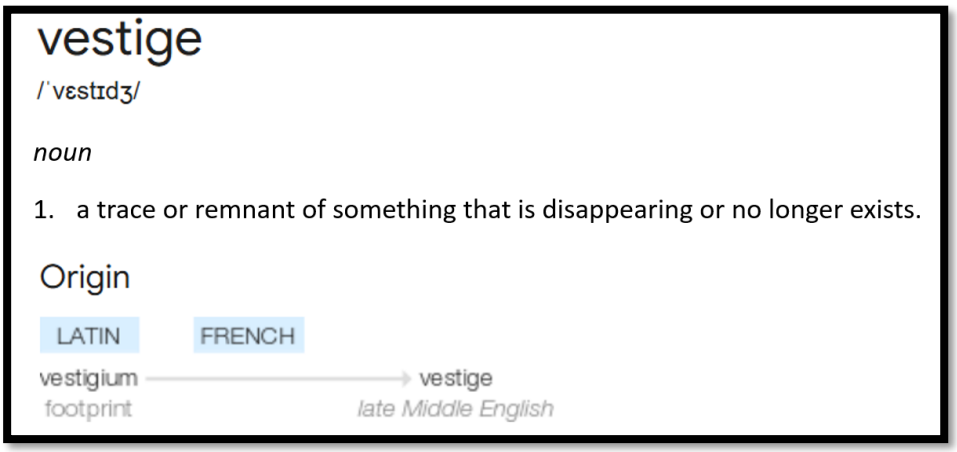
3.1 Refer to lines 1–4: 'Remember me when … yet turning stay.'

Discuss how the poet's use of punctuation is effective in portraying the meaning of these lines. (3)

3.2 Consider lines 5–8: 'Remember me when … then or pray.'

Explain how the pronouns ('you' and 'me') and possessive adjective ('our') heighten the emotion of the speaker. (2)

3.3 Refer to line 12: 'A vestige of the thoughts that once I had', and the definition of 'vestige' below:



[Adapted from: <https://languages.oup.com/google-dictionary-en/>]

Discuss why 'vestige' is effective in helping the reader understand the speaker's view of death. (3)

3.4 Refer to lines 13–14: 'Better by far … and be sad.'

Explain in what way these lines might be considered bittersweet for the speaker. (2)

3.5 Refer to 'Remember' (**TEXT 3A**), 'Ozymandias of Egypt' (**TEXT 3B**), and the extract below, and answer the question that follows.

> The sonnet explores inner conflict and self-awareness: a way of thinking about mankind. Its form provides a way to reflect on human nature, and it resolves emotional struggles.

[Adapted from: The Birth of the Modern Mind: The Invention of the Sonnet. By Paul Oppenheimer]

Critically evaluate whether each poet makes effective use of the sonnet form to explore 'inner conflict and self-awareness' and ultimately 'resolves emotional struggles'. Refer to specific details from **TEXT 3A** and **TEXT 3B** to support your response. (5)

[15]

IEB Copyright © 2025

QUESTION 4 UNSEEN POETRY

Refer to the poems, 'Call Of Nature' by Wendy Bureau (**TEXT 4A**) and 'Namaqualand after Rain' by William Plomer (**TEXT 4B**) on pages (vi) and (vii) of the Insert and then answer the questions that follow.

4.1 Refer to lines 1–8: 'Fog blankets the … lips, so fair'.

Explain how the imagery used enhances the visual impact of these lines. (3)

4.2 Refer to lines 9–11: 'A necessity of … a starving sponge'.

How does the poet's use of 'Sipping' (line 10) and 'Absorbing' (line 11) support the reader's understanding of these actions? (2)

4.3 Refer to line 12: 'During the calm before the storm'.

Explain whether line 12 is best understood literally or figuratively. (3)

4.4 Refer to lines 13–16: 'A miracle of … satisfied, Nature's call'.

Discuss how the alliteration highlights the relationship between the rain and nature. (3)

4.5 Refer to 'Call Of Nature' (**TEXT 4A**) and 'Namaqualand after Rain' (**TEXT 4B**) and answer the question that follows.

Critically discuss how each poet uses personification to enhance the mood of each poem. Refer to specific details from **TEXT 4A** and **TEXT 4B** to support your response. (4)
[15]

IEB Copyright © 2025

QUESTION 5 CRITICAL AND VISUAL LITERACY

Refer to **TEXT 5A**, **TEXT 5B**, **TEXT 5C** and **TEXT 5D** on pages (viii–xi) of the Insert. Examine all the texts before attempting to answer the questions that follow.

TEXT 5A, **TEXT 5B**, **TEXT 5C** and **TEXT 5D** are different advertisement campaigns against human trafficking.

5.1 Consider the following from **TEXT 5A**.



Discuss how the verbal details reinforce the importance of Sunitha Krishnan's work. (3)

5.2 Consider the following from **TEXT 5A**.

> Her work shines as a guiding light for survivors. igniting a spark of hope across society.

5.2.1 Rewrite the sentence, correcting the punctuation error. (1)

5.2.2 Explain whether the figure of speech used is clichéd. (3)

5.3 Refer to the following from **TEXT 5A**.



5.3.1 Considering the purpose of the above advertisement, discuss the effectiveness of the hashtag, '#societyunites'. (2)

5.3.2 Give a reason for the advertiser's use of 'apart' instead of 'a part'. (2)

IEB Copyright © 2025

5.4 Refer to **TEXT 5B**.

Discuss whether the layout of the advertisement is effective in portraying the horrific nature of human trafficking. Refer to the placement of specific visual and verbal details in it to support your response. (4)

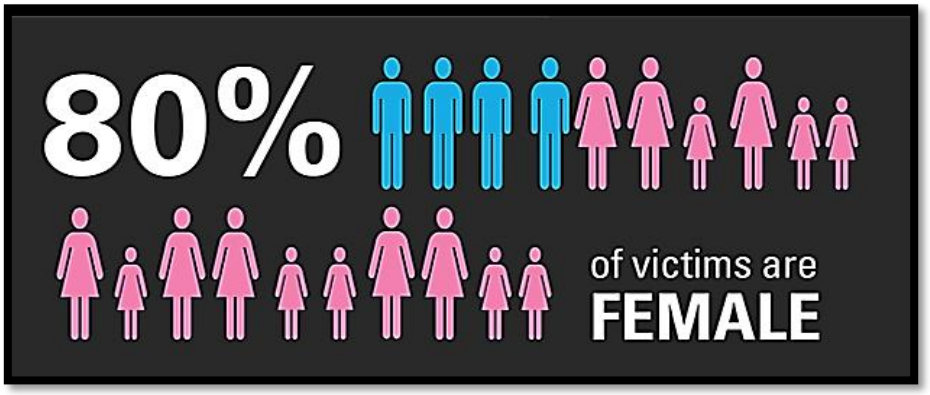
5.5 Consider the following from **TEXT 5B**.



5.5.1 Explain whether this is a simple, compound, or complex sentence. (2)

5.5.2 Discuss whether the sentence would have been more effective if the advertiser had used: 'We are here to help if this is happening to you.' (2)

5.6 Refer to the following from **TEXT 5C**.



Comment on whether the visualisation of the statistic is effective. (2)

5.7 Refer to **TEXT 5D**.

Considering the advertiser's intention, critically discuss why the advertisement (**TEXT 5D**) is effective in raising the reader's awareness of human trafficking. Refer to specific visual and verbal details from **TEXT 5D** to support your response. (4)
[25]

IEB Copyright © 2025

QUESTION 6 LANGUAGE

Refer to **TEXT 6** on page (xii) of the Insert and answer the questions that follow.

6.1 Refer to the following:

> **Oxford Word of the Year: '*Brain Rot*'**

Why has the writer used a colon in the title? (1)

6.2 Consider the following:

> The Oxford Word of the Year is '*brain rot*', defined as 'the supposed deterioration of a person's mental or intellectual state, especially due to over-consumption of material (now particularly online content) considered insignificant'.

Identify the function of the brackets in the context of these lines. (1)

6.3 Refer to lines 6–8 below:

> In the digital era, '*brain rot*' has recovered and regained its significance, particularly on platforms like TikTok among Gen Z and Gen Alpha, reflecting societal concerns about the impact of over-consuming low-value online content.

Explain whether 'recovered and regained' is an example of tautology. (1)

6.4 Consider lines 9–11 below:

> Today, '*brain rot*' is used to mockingly describe both the cause and effect of this phenomena: the low-quality content found online and the perceived harm it has on individuals and society.

6.4.1 Correct the split infinitive. (1)

6.4.2 Why should the writer have used 'phenomenon' instead of 'phenomena'? (1)

6.4.3 Identify the function of the hyphen in 'low-quality'. (1)

6.4.4 What is implied by the writer's use of 'perceived'? (1)

IEB Copyright © 2025

6.5 Refer to lines 17–20 below:

> Its adoption by younger generations – those both consuming and creating digital content – reveal a cheeky, self-aware perspective on the very culture it critiques, reflecting broader concerns about technologies role in modern life.

6.5.1 Identify the subject of the sentence. (1)

6.5.2 Identify and correct an error of concord. (1)

6.5.3 Why should the writer have used 'technology's role' instead of 'technologies role'? (1)

[10]

Total: 100 marks

IEB Copyright © 2025